A SHORT INTRODUCTION

BOOOKS

A living world for books

Boooks is an offline-first social reading platform where your books become part of a personal, explorable 3D world.

AARHUS, DENMARK

2026

CHAPTER 01

Books Should Feel Personal

Digital libraries are efficient, but they rarely feel like they belong to us.

They reduce books to rows, thumbnails and files, even though every book carries a memory, a place and a piece of who we are.

Boooks is designed to bring that feeling back.

CHAPTER 02

Your Reading World

Your library becomes a world you can explore.

Books sit on shelves, respond to touch and slowly build a visible picture of your reading life.

The goal is not to imitate a physical bookshelf perfectly. It is to create something more personal, playful and alive.

CHAPTER 03

Bring Your Books With You

Scan the front, spine and back of a book.

Boooks identifies the book, prepares its cover and creates a digital 3D version for your library.

A physical collection can gradually become a portable reading world, one book at a time.

CHAPTER 04

Read Your Way

Open a book directly from its 3D form.

Read offline, change the typography, save bookmarks, highlight passages and attach personal notes.

The reading experience is designed to remain calm and focused while the surrounding world makes returning feel inviting.

CHAPTER 05

Reading Can Be Social

Discover what friends are reading.

Share books, collections, progress and meaningful passages without turning reading into another noisy feed.

Boooks is built around curiosity and thoughtful connection, not endless engagement.

CHAPTER 06

Offline First

Your library should remain yours, even without a connection.

Books, progress, notes and essential features are stored locally first and synchronised when a connection becomes available.

Fast when online. Useful when offline. Personal by default.

CHAPTER 07

An Open Foundation for Books

Behind the experience, Boooks is exploring an open, distributed record for books.

This foundation can preserve a book's identity, editions, contributions and history across time, while keeping the complexity away from the reader.

The technology supports the world. It is not the world itself.

CHAPTER 08

Built for Learning Too

Boooks will be tested with schools and readers in real learning environments.

Schools are a core target group. That is why we are creating Boooks Challenges, where schools can compete through reading.

Competition can be healthy, and the research into reading physical books is compelling.

> *Reading changes your brain. Really.*

A spatial library can help students see progress, revisit highlights and develop reading as a daily habit and part of their identity.

The aim is not only to provide access to books, but to make people want to return to them.

READING RESEARCH

Reading Changes Your Brain. Really.

Ten snapshots from the science of reading. Each source is clickable.

01 MCGILL UNIVERSITY

Lower Psychological Distress

A year-long study of 231 university students associated recreational reading with reduced psychological distress.

Read the study

02 YALE UNIVERSITY / +23 MO

Lifespan Extension

A 12-year study of 3,635 adults found that book readers had a survival advantage over people who did not read books.

Read the study

03 CHINA MEDICAL UNIVERSITY / 14 YRS

Protection Against Cognitive Decline

More frequent reading predicted a lower risk of cognitive decline among older adults across a 14-year follow-up.

Read the study

04 RUSH UNIVERSITY MEDICAL CENTER / 33%

Lower Alzheimer's Risk

Frequent participation in activities such as reading was associated with reduced Alzheimer's risk and slower cognitive decline.

Read the study

05 THE NEW SCHOOL FOR SOCIAL RESEARCH / 5

Empathy and Social Cognition

Five experiments found that reading literary fiction temporarily improved performance on tests of theory of mind.

Read the study

06 NATIONAL LITERACY TRUST / 59%

Mental Wellbeing

Children and young people reported that reading helped them relax, feel happy and confident, and deal with problems.

Read the study

07 OXFORD UNIVERSITY PRESS / 84%

Vocabulary and Emotional Literacy

More than four in five children surveyed said reading helps them learn new words for feelings and emotions.

Read the study

08 THE READING AGENCY / 68%

Combating Loneliness

Reading Friends participants reported feeling more connected to other people and less lonely.

Read the study

09 STANFORD UNIVERSITY

Deep Reading and the Brain

Brain imaging found that close literary reading engaged complex patterns of brain activity beyond reading for pleasure.

Read the study

10 UNIVERSITY OF KENT & WUERZBURG / 184

Cognitive Benefits of Fiction

Two preregistered meta-analyses found small cognitive benefits from reading fiction, especially for verbal ability and social cognition.

Read the study

CHAPTER 09

Currently in Development

Boooks is being built with React, React Three Fiber and Three.js.

Current work includes the 3D library, book scanner, reader, offline storage, social features and the infrastructure behind a shared book ecosystem.

It is early, but it is becoming a real application.

The books in this showcase have all been scanned using a phone. We plan to add automatic cropping with machine learning. For now, OpenCV lets you set four points, then automatically crops and warps the cover.

The books shown on the page were added through the mock-up. The scanner itself is not included in the demo, and only its preview uses Three.js. The scope has deliberately been limited so the first part can be polished without overwhelming visitors.

A CLOSING NOTE

Help Build the World Around Reading

Boooks is looking for early readers, schools, designers, developers and curious people who want to contribute. Anything is welcome! And yes, we are building a non-profit - not like Sam Altman! ;)

JOIN THE BETA

boooks.app

EXPLORE THE PROJECT

boooks.app/threejs

Jacob Bonde

AARHUS, DENMARK